2026 October Predictions Module 2

1.

Despite a growing view among young people and others in South Africa that celebrated anti-apartheid leader Nelson Mandela should have taken greater strides as president to effect more substantive structural changes in the country's stratified society, years after his death in 2013 Mandela continues to be _____ by many worldwide.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A lauded

B reinterpreted

C evaluated

D criticized

2.

The swordfish is ectothermic, or cold-blooded, and the southern bluefin tuna is a regional endotherm, meaning that parts of its body are typically warmer than the surrounding water. The basking shark had been classified as a full ectotherm, a position that became _____ after researchers Haley R. Dolton and colleagues showed that the basking shark's body temperature is consistently 1.0 to 1.5°C warmer than the water.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A inconsolable

B unanticipated

C unequivocal

D untenable

3.

Paleontologists think that Ornithomimus, Phuwiangosaurus, and other long-extinct theropods and sauropods may have breathed using air sacs connected to tubelike extensions inside the animals' bones. Such structures are found in modern birds, which is why some paleontologists treat the respiratory systems of birds as _____ those of Ornithomimus, Phuwiangosaurus, and other theropods and sauropods.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A harbingers of

B proxies for

C emissaries for

D subordinates of

4.

Although more documentaries are being made than ever before, too many seem _____, offering stories without any depth. In a refreshing contrast, Ahmir "Questlove" Thompson's 2021 documentary *Summer of Soul (...or, When the Revolution Could Not Be Televised)* draws from present-day interviews to supply compelling historical and social context for footage of the 1969 Harlem Cultural Festival.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A cryptic

B inaccessible

C haughty

D perfunctory

5.

Vertical gene transfer involves the transmission of genetic material from a parent to offspring; horizontal gene transfer, on the other hand, involves the exchange of genetic material between organisms not in a parent-offspring relationship. While horizontal gene transfer is common among prokaryotes—single-celled organisms, such as the bacteria *Brevundimonas diminuta* and *Lactobacillus curvatus*—it has rarely been observed among eukaryotes (multicellular organisms). However, new studies suggest that horizontal gene transfer is more common in eukaryotes than originally thought.

Which choice best states the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

A It argues that two biological phenomena are more similar than they may initially appear to be.

B It proposes a direction for future research into a biological phenomenon.

C It explains why a common perception of a biological process is flawed.

D It explains a biological process by contrasting it with a somewhat similar process.

6.

Harold Newton's *Yellow Day*, a wetland landscape with palm trees and lush greenery set against the pastel yellows and pinks of the sky and water, is typical of paintings by the Florida Highwaymen, loosely affiliated landscape artists mainly active in Fort Pierce, Florida, during the 1950s and '60s. Some art historians suggest that Highwaymen paintings played a role in shaping popular perceptions of the state that persist today: the natural iconography that Newton and colleagues constantly revisited—lush tropical forests, vivid sunsets—is now seen as classically Floridian.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A To explain that a particular painting by Harold Newton has had greater influence on the broader culture of the state of Florida than is generally acknowledged

B To contrast the public's reaction during the 1950s and '60s to a particular painting by Harold Newton with more recent reactions to it

C To describe the historical circumstances in which paintings by the Florida Highwaymen experienced a resurgence in popularity

D To present the argument that paintings by the Florida Highwaymen likely helped to create a particular widespread impression of Florida

7.

The following text is from Anne Spencer's 1922 poem "Translation."

We trekked into a far country,
My friend and I.
Our deeper content was never spoken,
But each knew all the other said.
He told me how calm his soul was laid
By the lack of anvil and strife.
"The wooing kestrel," I said, "mutes his mating-note
To please the harmony of this sweet silence."

Which choice best describes the function of the reference to "anvil and strife" in the text as a whole?

A It emphasizes the way that nature provides a contrast to the feelings of the speaker and her friend.

B It illustrates how the speaker and her friend understand each other's feelings without having to talk about them.

C It represents a strong contrast to the speaker's friend's current experience of tranquility.

D It symbolizes the speaker's friend's view that meaningful work and social engagement are core components of a fulfilling life.

8.

The following text is from Ralph Waldo Emerson's 1841 essay "The Method of Nature."

The scholars are the priests of that thought which establishes the foundations of the earth. No matter what is their special work or profession, they stand for the spiritual interest of the world, and it is a common calamity if they neglect their post in a country where the material interest is so predominant as it is in America.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A Scholars have played an important role in society for a much longer time than have those people who are mainly concerned with financial gain.

B The habit of intellectuals of privileging ideas over material things invariably leads to tragedy.

C In a country whose citizens are largely preoccupied with tangible gains, it is crucial that some people work to foster and preserve ideas.

D It is important for Americans of all kinds to have at least some military experience if society is to function properly.

9.

The Clouds is a 423 BCE play by Aristophanes, originally written in ancient Greek. At the time, professional intellectuals called sophists taught customers rhetorical techniques to use in public speaking, along with providing instruction in other subjects. In the play, Aristophanes satirizes sophists as having an exaggerated sense of their own wisdom, as seen when the character _____.

Which choice most effectively uses a quotation from a translation of *The Clouds* to illustrate the claim?

A Strepsiades encourages his son to learn to be a sophist, saying, "If you have any concern for your father's patrimony, become one of them."

B Strepsiades says of a sophist business, "There dwell men who in speaking of the heavens persuade people that it is an oven, and that it encompasses us, and that we are the embers. These men teach, if one give them money, to conquer in speaking, right or wrong."

C Socrates, a sophist, says to a new customer, "Come, then, take care that whenever I propound any clever dogma about abstruse matters, you [seize] immediately."

D Socrates, a sophist, says of a new customer, "I have not seen any man so boorish, nor so impracticable, nor so stupid, nor so forgetful; who, while learning some little petty quibbles, forgets them before he has learned them".

10.

$^{87}Sr/^{86}Sr$	Age (Ma)
0.708980	6.20
0.709000	5.86
0.709020	5.40
0.709040	4.75
0.709060	3.00

The late Hemphillian (Hh) North American Land Mammal Age includes the subdivisions Hh3, 6.8 million years ago (Ma) to 6 Ma, and Hh4, 6 Ma to 4.75 Ma. While mammalian fossils have indicated that Florida's Montbrook Fossil Site (MFS) and Palmetto Fauna of the Bone Valley Region (PFBV) date to Hh4, a more precise determination of the sites' ages has proved challenging. Stephanie R. Killingsworth et al. compared average ratios of strontium-87 to strontium-86 (87Sr/86Sr) in fossil shark teeth from MFS and PFBV—0.709000 and 0.709028, respectively—to 87Sr/86Sr ratios in the global strontium seawater curve, a record that shows how 87Sr/86Sr ratios in seawater correspond to numerical ages and that is used to date fossils and, by extension, fossil sites. The researchers concluded that _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A mammalian fossil evidence offers less dating precision than do 87Sr/86Sr ratios in fossil shark teeth and that PFBV likely was deposited closer to the Hh3-Hh4 boundary than was MFS.

B the average 87Sr/86Sr ratios in the fossil shark teeth from MFS and PFBV resolve previous uncertainty about the sites' relative ages by indicating that both sites were deposited contemporaneously during the late Hh.

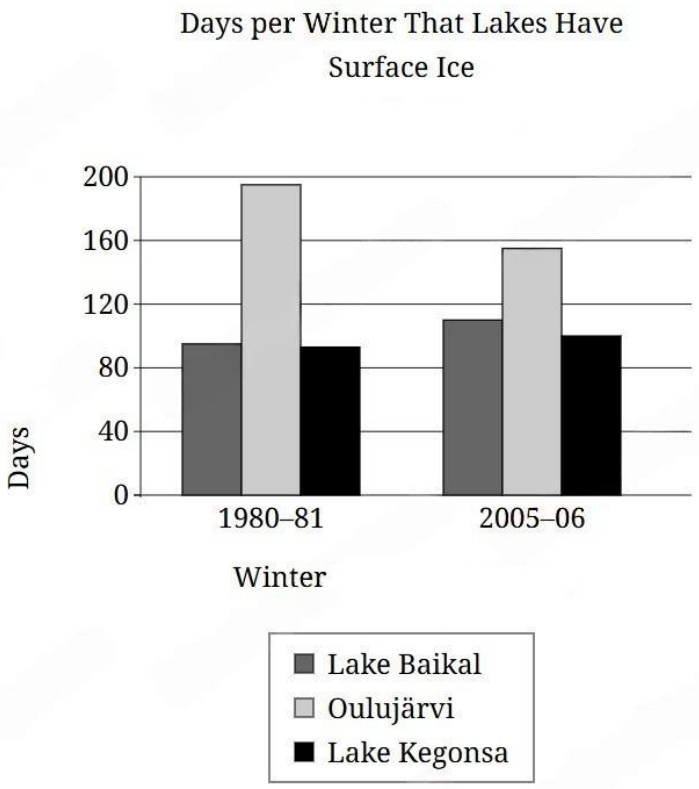
C the average 87Sr/86Sr ratios in the fossil shark teeth from MFS and PFBV only partially support the site age estimates previously established through mammalian fossil evidence.

D the average 87Sr/86Sr ratios in the fossil shark teeth from MFS and PFBV corroborate that both MFS and PFBV fall within Hh4 but suggest that PFBV was likely deposited more recently than MFS.

11.

It is common for freshwater lakes near or above a latitude of 45° north of the equator, like Lake Stechlin in Germany, to accumulate surface ice in winter. A study from 1980 to 2006 showed that, in general, the number of days per winter that such lakes have measurable amounts of surface ice is declining. However, a researcher claimed that some lakes have instead seen an increase in the duration of ice, citing as an example _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the researcher's example?



A both Lake Kegonsa and Oulujärvi, which had more days of ice in the winter of 2005–06 than they did in the winter of 1980–81.

B both Lake Baikal and Oulujärvi, which had more than 100 days of ice in the winter of 2005–06.

C Lake Baikal, which had more days of ice in the winter of 2005–06 than it did in the winter of 1980–81.

D both Lake Baikal and Oulujärvi, which had fewer than 195 days of ice in the winter of 1980–81.

12.

Edinburgh, Scotland, has installed engineered structures along 89% of its shoreline to protect infrastructure from wave erosion and other hazards, a practice known as shoreline hardening. To evaluate the responses of waterbirds to two types of hardening structures—riprap and bulkheads—Diann Prosser et al. surveyed waterbird communities consisting of the osprey, the common tern, and 62 other species at different sites in the Chesapeake Bay on the US East Coast. Utilizing the Index of Waterbird Community Integrity (IWCI), on which a high score corresponds to high community integrity, the researchers found that bulkheads are more strongly negatively correlated with waterbird community integrity than is riprap.

Which finding, if true, would most directly illustrate the researchers' finding?

A A location with high levels of both bulkheads and riprap had a lower average IWCI score than a location with low levels of both.

B A location with a high percentage of bulkheads had a lower average IWCI score than a location with a high percentage of riprap.

C A location with equal amounts of bulkheads and riprap had a higher average IWCI score than a location with unequal amounts of the two structures.

D There was no statistically significant difference in IWCI scores between two separate locations that both featured more bulkheads than riprap.

13.

A student is writing a research paper on the history of irrigation in the southwestern United States, situating the development of Lake Sabrina (a man-made body of water created in Inyo County, California, in 1908) in a larger historical context. The student claims that some modern-day irrigation methods used in southwestern states, such as California, Arizona, and New Mexico, have a lineage that long predates the completion of Lake Sabrina.

Which quotation from a historian best supports the student's claim?

A "Sprinkler irrigation systems, which were developed in the late 20th century, are a convenient technique of irrigating that makes use of machinery in order to spray water in all directions. Many areas of the Southwestern United States are currently irrigated by this method."

B "The importance of the development of irrigation infrastructure in the American Southwest today cannot be overstated, since it is the most common means of conveying water for food production."

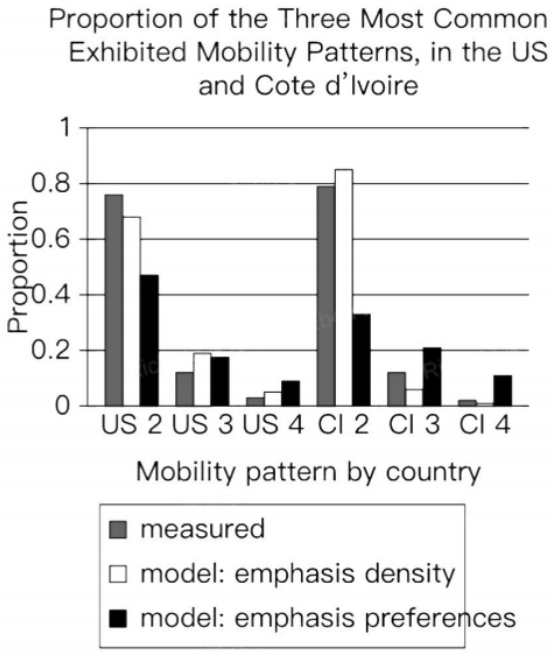
C "In the decades following the Second World War, irrigation of arid areas for agriculture increased to such a degree that it now accounts for roughly 70% of the world's water usage."

D "The irrigation system developed by the Hohokam people in what is now central Arizona in the 7th century CE was simple but made use of hydraulic engineering design principles that are still utilized by today's engineers."

14.

Researchers used anonymized location data from the US and Côte d'Ivoire to document people's daily patterns of mobility, using these results to test the efficacy of the researchers' predictive computer model. In each country, unidirectional cycles among two, three, or four locations were empirically the most common pattern types; the graph shows each of these pattern types as a proportion of all pattern instances found for that country (e.g., the measured value for CI 3 in the graph, 0.12, indicates that the three-location pattern constituted 12% of all pattern instances in the Côte d'Ivoire data). The researchers ran their model twice under different assumptions, concluding that emphasizing the salience of local population density over personal preferences generally yielded the best results.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to illustrate the researchers' conclusion?



A Under the assumption that preferences are more salient than density, the US 2 and CI 2 proportions were predicted to be approximately 0.45 and 0.35, respectively, both below the measured values, whereas under the other assumption, the model overestimated the proportion for US 2 and overestimated that for CI 2.

B Under the assumption that preferences are more salient than density, the US 2 and CI 2 proportions were predicted to be in the range of 0.3 to 0.5, placing them farther from the measured values than were those predicted under the other assumption.

C Under the assumption that density is more salient than preferences, the US 2 and CI 2 proportions are approximately 0.65 and 0.85, respectively, significantly higher than the values predicted under the other assumption and thus farther than those predictions from the measured values.

D Under the assumption that preferences are more salient than density, the two-location patterns (US 2 and CI 2) were predicted to be most frequent in the data even though neither proportion was projected to exceed 0.5, well below the proportion predicted under the other assumption.

15.

Whereas Rebecca M. Harrison and Pia Nystrom's 2001 study of captive bonobos reported more right-handedness than left-handedness, Jane Goodall's 1963 study of wild chimpanzees did not. According to a meta-analysis of studies of nonhuman primates, captive populations are more likely to be described as right-handed than wild populations are. Statistical analysis indicates a handedness study would need a minimum of 176 individuals to show a representative result; however, the study by Harrison and Nystrom included a total population of 19, and the study by Goodall included a total population of 8. This suggests that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A Goodall likely underestimated the prevalence of right-handedness among the wild chimpanzees in the study.

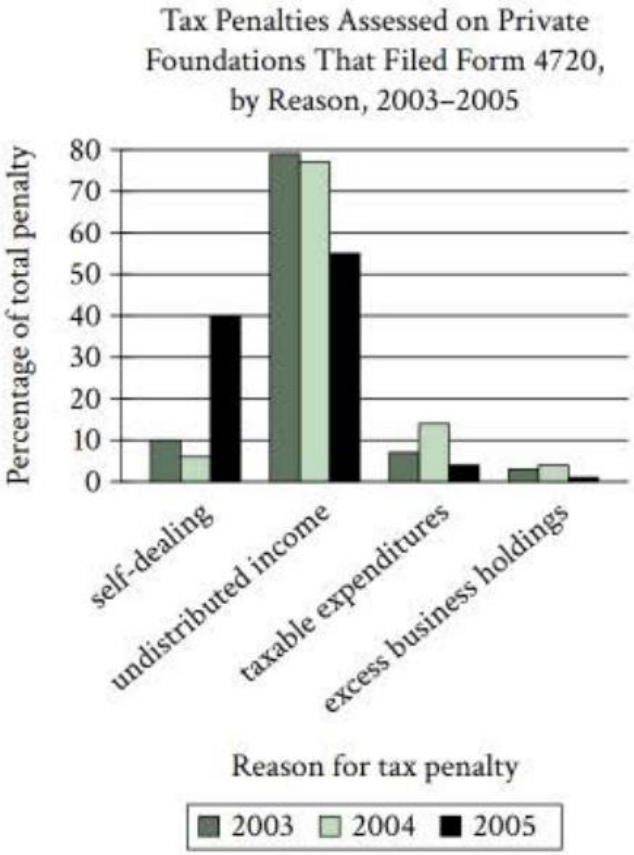
B the study by Harrison and Nystrom reliably represents handedness in captive primates but not in wild primates.

C the study by Harrison and Nystrom reliably represents handedness in captive primates, but the study by Goodall likely does not reliably represent handedness in wild primates.

D neither the study by Harrison and Nystrom nor the study by Goodall provides sufficient evidence to make a meaningful comparison about handedness in primates.

16.

While US public charities, like Commonfund, must file Form 990 yearly with the IRS, private foundations, such as the David and Lucile Packard Foundation, must file a different form, 990-PF. In addition, foundations that engage in certain prohibited activities must also file Form 4720 and pay a penalty tax on the money involved. Private foundations are prohibited from holding excess interests in a business enterprise, "self-dealing" (conducting activities that benefit foundation insiders), making taxable expenditures such as outlays for lobbying, and failing to cross a required threshold in making charitable distributions from income. Out of the organizations that filed Form 990-PF in the years 2003–2005, _____.



A a smaller percentage of those that also filed Form 4720 did so because they engaged in self-dealing than the percentage of those that filed Form 4720 because they did not meet the minimum charitable distribution requirement.

B those that also filed Form 4720 paid a larger penalty for failing to meet a minimum charitable distribution requirement than those organizations that filed Form 990 but also filed Form 4720 for the same reason.

C those that were also required to file Form 4720 because they had excess holdings in a business enterprise paid, on average, a larger penalty than those organizations that filed Form 4720 because they made taxable expenditures.

D those that also filed Form 4720 collectively paid larger penalties for failing to meet the minimum charitable distribution requirement than for other reasons.

17.

In economics, mustard seeds are considered a commodity because they are essentially interchangeable, "essentially" being a word that admits a degree of latitude. In 2021, researchers J. Shorish, M. Stephenson, and M. Zargham devised a mathematical model of fungibility (interchangeability) that would account for such variation. Distinguishing "exactly the same" and "nearly the same" commodities—whether crops, lumber, or precious metals—_____ among their primary aims.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A having been

B being

C was

D were

18.

Painter Georgette _____ for incorporating everyday objects from her Singaporean environment—such as lanterns, mooncakes, and tropical fruits—into her still-life compositions, was a pivotal figure in the mid-twentieth-century Nanyang art movement, which sought to blend European painting traditions (including still life) with elements of Southeast Asian cultures and art.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A Chen, was known

B Chen, known

C Chen was known

D Chen is known

19.

According to Roxana Silbert, former artistic director of Hampstead Theatre, the past five decades have seen UK theater companies—once operated as artist cooperatives like the Royal Exchange (with its five founding artistic directors)—evolving toward increasingly corporate structures, with executives rather than creatives _____ decision-making power over programming.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A have been given

B are being given

C being given

D been given

20.

"Streetwide and bitter as hope / strewn between El Salvador and San Francisco." These lines are from a poem by Chicano _____ whose early career as a campesino informs the dialogue on Mexican American politics and identity that unfolds in his work.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A writer Juan Felipe Herrera,

B writer, Juan Felipe Herrera

C writer , Juan Felipe Herrera,

D writer Juan Felipe Herrera

21.

The legacy of the Spanish Empire, which once controlled portions of five continents, is evident in Spanish-speaking Uruguay, one of many places that reveal their imperial history in their language. Contrast Uruguay with Belgium, which ceased to be part of the empire in _____ the latter's connection to the empire is so attenuated that Spanish is seldom spoken there today.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A 1714 and

B 1714

C 1714,

D 1714:

22.

As part of his effort to identify Bronze Age pathways across Sicily, archaeologist Dario Calderone created three-dimensional digital models of the terrain via aerial photogrammetry. The drone _____ the landscape, which included archaeological sites from as far back as the Early Neolithic Period, flew in a pattern that ensured 60 percent forward overlap and 20 percent side overlap between individual images.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A photographs

B photographing

C was photographing

D photographed

23.

The Rajahnate of Butuan, a sea power based on Mindanao island in the Philippines that reached the height of its influence around 1100 CE, is classified as a thalassocracy. Thalassocracies are generally considered distinct from tellurocracies, or land-based powers. _____ the British Empire (1600s–1900s CE) notably extended its hegemony across both land and sea.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A Exemplifying this distinction,

B Underscoring this difference,

C Supporting this claim,

D Blurring this line,

24.

According to climate envelope models, individual organisms that inhabit the coolest areas of their species' geographic distribution are expected to benefit from a warming climate, while individuals in the warmest areas will struggle. A 2024 University of Arizona study, _____ found that warmer-than-average temperatures resulted in a decrease in growth across all areas of the common piñon tree's distribution range.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A though,

B therefore,

C for example,

D moreover,

25.

As technology has advanced, many countries have sought to gain an advantage in, or even control parts of, space and its celestial bodies. _____ it is the 1967 Outer Space Treaty, signed by Austria, Finland, and over 100 other nations, that curtails these ambitions and ensures that space remains a neutral place for the international community.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A Consequently,

B Specifically,

C Alternatively,

D Ultimately,

26.

- The Highpointers Club is a hiking club.
- One of the main goals among club members is to reach the highest points in all fifty US states.
- Those who achieve this are called 50 Completers.
- In Suk Han became a 50 Completer on November 15, 2013.
- The highest point in Wisconsin is Timms Hill, at 1,951 ft.
- The highest point in Wyoming is Gannett Peak, at 13,809 ft.

Which choice most effectively uses information from the given sentences to explain the 50 Completers hiking challenge to a new audience?

A If you are looking for a new hiking challenge, consider joining the Highpointers Club, as did In Suk Han, a hiker who successfully reached the highest point in every US state.

B Not until after you have reached the highest points in all fifty US states—including Timms Hill in Wisconsin and Gannett Peak in Wyoming—can you include yourself among the 50 Completers of the Highpointers Club.

C On November 15, 2013, In Suk Han finally completed the feat of reaching the highest point in all fifty US states, including Timms Hill in Wisconsin and Gannett Peak in Wyoming.

D Hikers aiming to count themselves among the 50 Completers must reach not only Wisconsin's Timms Hill but also the even higher peak of Gannett Peak in Wyoming.

27.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- 1992 was the 500th anniversary (quincentennial) of Columbus's first voyage to the Americas.
- 1992: Native artist Jaune Quick-to-See Smith (Confederated Salish and Kootenai Tribes) curated a traveling art exhibition titled *The Submuloc Show/Columbus Wohs*.
- Smith called the exhibition "a visual commentary on the Columbus quincentennial from the perspective of America's first people."
- In a 2020 article, art historian Ariel Bonilla analyzed Smith's response to the Columbus quincentennial celebration.
- Bonilla: "Smith used her curatorial role to create a counter-narrative...visualizing the Native American survival of Columbian conquest."
- Bonilla: Smith's show was "disinterested in financial gain as a primary or even secondary motivation."

The student wants to use a quotation from Bonilla to explain Smith's motivation for curating the show. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A According to Bonilla, Smith's "primary or even secondary motivation" for curating the show was to analyze Columbus from the perspective of a Native artist.

B According to Bonilla, Smith was "disinterested in financial gain as a primary or even secondary motivation" in her curation of the exhibition, a celebration of the 500th anniversary of Columbus's first voyage to the Americas.

C According to Bonilla, Smith curated the exhibition to "create a counter-narrative" in response to the Columbus quincentennial, one focused instead on "Native American survival."

D According to Bonilla, Smith curated The Submuloc Show/Columbus Wohs as "a visual commentary on the Columbus quincentennial from the perspective of America's first people."